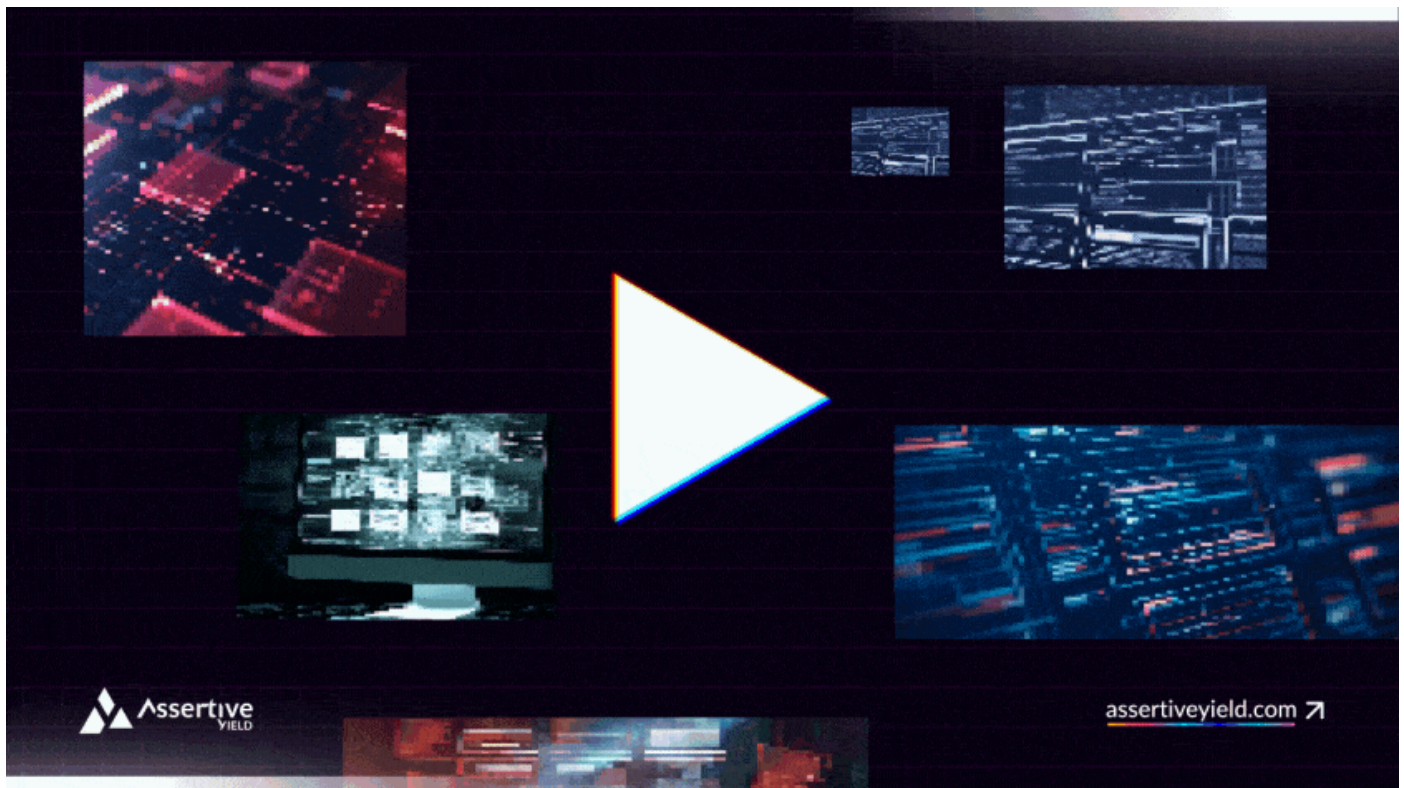


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Microsoft/Xandr Prebid Cache Deprecation: A Publisher's Guide to a Safe Migration

On December 12, 2025, Microsoft announced that its public/shared Prebid Cache endpoint is being deprecated, which means any publisher still relying on it needs to switch to a different caching approach. According to Microsoft, this change and the public cache deprecation take effect on April 30, 2026.



Caching isn't the most visible part of video monetization, but it's one of those "small" dependencies that can quietly cause big delivery problems if it's tied to the wrong endpoint.

On December 12, 2025, [Microsoft announced](#) that its public/shared Prebid Cache endpoint is being deprecated, which means any publisher still relying on it needs to switch to a different caching approach. According to Microsoft, this change and the public cache deprecation take effect on April 30, 2026.

If your Prebid video setup still uses that shared cache host (often because it was a default in older implementations), the smart move is to migrate early, while you have time to test and avoid any surprise dips in fill or playback.

What's Changing

In many Prebid video setups, the winning bid comes back as VAST XML (basically the instructions for what ad to play, where to track it, and where the media file lives). But video players and ad servers usually don't want to pass a big XML blob around. They prefer a simple URL they can call right when the ad needs to run.

That's what caching is doing in the background: Prebid stores the VAST temporarily, gets back a key (UUID), and the player later fetches the VAST using a URL like:

What This Means for Video Ads

If your player can't retrieve VAST at playback time, the ad often won't run, which means:

- Fill drops even when demand is strong (because delivery fails after the auction)
- More timeouts and playback errors that hurt user experience
- Fewer billable impressions and completes, which hit revenue directly
- Harder troubleshooting, because it can look like a bidder issue, a player bug, or “something weird in GAM.”

Video is usually a high-CPM surface. So even a small increase in failed delivery can show up quickly in weekly reporting.

Impact on Ad Revenue

Here's the simple handoff:

1. Prebid runs the auction
2. The winning VAST is stored temporarily in a cache
3. Prebid gets a UUID (think: a claim ticket)
4. The player uses that UUID to fetch the VAST right before playback

So if the cache endpoint you're using is deprecated and you don't migrate, the player still tries to “claim the ticket”, but there's nothing behind it. That's when you see blank ads, errors, or timeouts.

What's the Solution?

Option 1: Local caching (store VAST in the browser/page)

The VAST stays local (in the browser session) instead of being stored on a remote cache server.

Pros

- Fewer external dependencies
- Often fewer network calls (can be faster)

Cons

- Not compatible with every player/ad server workflow
- Can behave differently across browsers/devices
- When issues happen, debugging is more client-side

Best for: Publishers with modern player setups and strong control over on-page logic.

Option 2: Publisher-hosted cache (run your own cache endpoint)

You host a Prebid-compatible cache endpoint and point your stack to it.

Pros

- Full control over uptime, logging, and security
- Works well with the common “UUID + fetch later” video pattern
- Removes reliance on any shared public endpoint

Cons

- Engineering time to deploy and maintain
- You own scaling, monitoring, and on-call
- If it breaks, video revenue is impacted immediately

Best for: Teams with engineering capacity who want maximum control.

Option 3: Managed cache via Prebid Server (vendor-operated, publisher-configured)

You use a managed Prebid Server environment that includes a stable cache endpoint, without running it day-to-day yourself.

Pros

- Usually, the quickest, lowest-risk migration
- Lower operational overhead
- Reliability and monitoring are typically stronger by default

- Vendor dependency (choose carefully)
- Less deep customization than self-hosting
- Ongoing cost (often lower than internal ops cost)

Best for: Publishers who want stability and speed without building and maintaining new services.

The best approach for you

A simple way to choose:

- Local caching if your player supports it cleanly and you want the lightest infrastructure.
- Publisher-hosted cache if you have engineering resources and want full control.
- Managed cache via Prebid Server if you want the fastest path with the least operational burden.

Whatever you choose, plan for a proper rollout: audit where VAST is fetched, test across key browsers/devices and top placements, then monitor fill, timeouts/errors, time-to-first-ad, and completion rate after launch.

How Assertive Yield makes the switch easier

Assertive Yield helps publishers migrate away from public cache dependencies while keeping ad delivery stable. With [Yield Manager](#), teams can roll out changes in a controlled way, test safely, iterate quickly, and roll back instantly if performance shifts.

[Talk to us](#) to learn more about selecting the best migration plan that fits your ad stack setup.

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Written by



Vaibhav Pandey

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Vaibhav Pandey is a Product Marketing Manager focused on making “what we built” instantly understandable and easy to sell. He partners with product and revenue teams to shape positioning, sharpen messaging, and build launch and enablement tools that move adoption and pipeline.

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